

OPENS SATURDAY, 8 AUGUST

Nobody Ever Built You Something Good To Learn From

So we did. Four courses, written from nothing, that open on your phone and remember where you stopped. Here is what it is, why it works differently to everything you have been handed so far, and how to get in this weekend.

A five-minute read · August 2026

Bookless · bookless.app

START HERE

Try to name who wrote your notes

Open whatever you are revising from tonight and try to name the person who wrote it. Most students cannot.

A classmate sent them to you. They got them from someone in the year above, who got them from someone who graduated three years ago. Somewhere down that chain the pages were photocopied, screenshotted and forwarded so many times that the author is gone and so are four of the pages. Half of it is written in the shorthand people use at 2am for themselves, and the examples do not match what your lecturer taught this semester.

So the week before the exam you are building one clear understanding out of three people's handwriting, a textbook priced for somebody in another country, and a video made for a syllabus that is not yours. At eleven at night, when a sentence stops making sense, there is nobody to ask.

That is not a discipline problem and it is not an intelligence problem. It is a materials problem. Nobody ever built you anything good to learn from.

WHAT IT IS

A course you read, not a folder you download

Bookless is one place you open on your phone. You pick a course, you get a list of steps, and each step is about ten minutes of reading written to be understood the first time rather than skimmed the night before. Nothing to install, nothing to lose in a WhatsApp thread. Close it on the bus and it opens on the same paragraph in your room.

Every step was written from scratch, in plain English, with the examples in kwacha and the companies ones you have heard of. Four courses are on it this weekend.

Course	Steps	What it goes through
Economics	25	Supply and demand, market structures, inflation, how people decide
Corporate Finance	25	Time value of money, appraisal, cost of capital, capital structure
Treasury Management	21	Liquidity and cash, funding, risk and hedging, controls
Strategic Management	7	Environment analysis, competitive position, choosing a strategy

That is 78 steps already written, with more added every week. If you have sat one of those courses you know what a semester of it costs you in photocopying alone.

WHY IT IS DIFFERENT

You cannot tick your way through it

This is the part that matters, and it is the part no PDF and no group chat can do. Five things are built into the reading itself.

A section ends with a question, not a tick box

Finish a section and you are asked something about what you just read. Get it wrong the first time and you are told only that it was wrong, then sent back to the text. You are deliberately not shown the right answer, because then "try again" would just mean clicking the green one. Miss it twice and the answer and the reason are both shown, and you still have to pick it yourself to move on. **The tick is always earned.**

Any word you do not know is one tap away

Words the material assumes you already own are underlined. Tap one and the definition appears beside it, then goes away. A definition sitting in brackets in the sentence is read by everyone, including the person who already knew the word, and it breaks the sentence for them every time. This way it is paid for only by the reader who needs it.

Every claim shows you where it came from

Under the paragraph that makes a claim sits a row of small chips naming the sources it rests on. Not a reading list at the end that nobody opens. Directly under the sentence, so you can see at a glance what a paragraph is standing on and go check it if you want to.

The study clock undercounts on purpose

Time only counts while the tab is actually in front of you and you have moved in the last minute. Leave a step open while you make tea and the clock stops. Read a long passage perfectly still and that minute is quietly lost. It is built to be too strict rather than too generous, because a study streak you can fake is worth nothing to you.

It asks you how the section read

Beside each checkpoint you can say how the writing landed. That goes straight into the next version of the step. Students who join this weekend are not reading a finished product, they are deciding what it becomes.

Your progress is measured rather than claimed. What survives is what you can actually answer, which is also the only thing worth having in an exam hall.

THE BIGGER IDEA

Your timetable is not on the internet

Building a course for every student in Zambia meant first finding out what every student is taught. Ten universities were checked properly, page by page, in the first week of August.

Seven of them publish no course list anywhere. Not a bad one. None. Programme names and entry requirements, and then nothing. Of the three that publish anything, one prints "Coming soon" on 98 of its 111 programme pages and another says "No Course List Found" on 106 of 107. **Nobody has written down what Zambian students are being taught.**

So it is being written down by the students. When you sign up you are asked your university, your programme, your year, and the courses you are actually taking this semester. Where the timetable is known you tick it in about fifteen seconds. Where it is not, you type it, and what you type is offered to the next person on your programme.

The first student on a programme types eight course names into an empty box. The fifth confirms a list better than anything the university has ever published.

602 distinct courses are mapped so far, deduped across campuses so that building one serves everybody who sits it. Four are built. The rest are ranked by how many students each would reach, which is how the order is decided. Signing up and putting your real timetable in is how yours moves up that list.

WHERE IT GOES

Passing is the entry point, not the point

Every question you answer is a small piece of evidence that you can do a specific thing. Discount a cash flow. Read a hedge. Spot where a strategy is exposed. On their own they are checkpoints. Stacked up over two years they are something a line on a CV cannot be: proof, with a record behind it.

Where this is going is the most reliable place in the country for a business to find someone who can genuinely do the work, instead of someone who wrote that they can. That is not built yet and you should not join for it. It is being built in order, and the studying is the part that is ready now.

BE CLEAR ABOUT IT

What you are actually getting on Saturday

Four courses is not your whole degree, so here is the plain version.

- Four courses are live. If yours is not one of them, it is not there yet.
- Steps are added every week, and the ones already up get rewritten when readers say they were unclear.
- Something will break. You will be told when it does rather than finding it quietly fixed.
- What you say about a section changes it. That is the whole point of joining in the first week.

If your course is not one of the four, come in anyway.

Sign up, put your real timetable in, and yours enters the queue with your name on the count. The order is decided by how many students ask for a course, and right now a single student moves a course several places.

HOW TO GET IN

One word

Booklessss opens this Saturday, 8 August. There is nothing to download, no card to enter, and it works on the phone you are reading this on.

Comment "Booklessss" under the post and the link comes to you the morning it opens.

That is it. First names on the list get first pick of the courses that get built next.

You have already done the hard part, which was showing up to the lectures. The only thing missing was something decent to read afterwards.